

Feedback Beta Study Summarized Synthesis Notes

(For SCO & AFC)

Location 1:

SCO

Date: Wednesday, May 1, 2024

Location 2:

Ali Forney Center

Date: Thursday, May 2, 2024

Consolidated Findings and Next Steps - Prioritized

by Gavilán Longino

May 10, 2024

Purpose

To evaluate the experience for clients to provide feedback to social services through the Feedback Feature Streetlives is building.

Objectives

- Is the experience easy to understand and use?
- Does the experience effectively guide users to provide feedback that is actionable for providers?

Major decisions to be made based on the research:

- Anything that needs updating for the highlight section?
- Stars or smileys?
- Are providers willing and able to provide information for the Traffic Chart?
- Do users find the comments section beneficial, and are providers willing and able to reply to users?

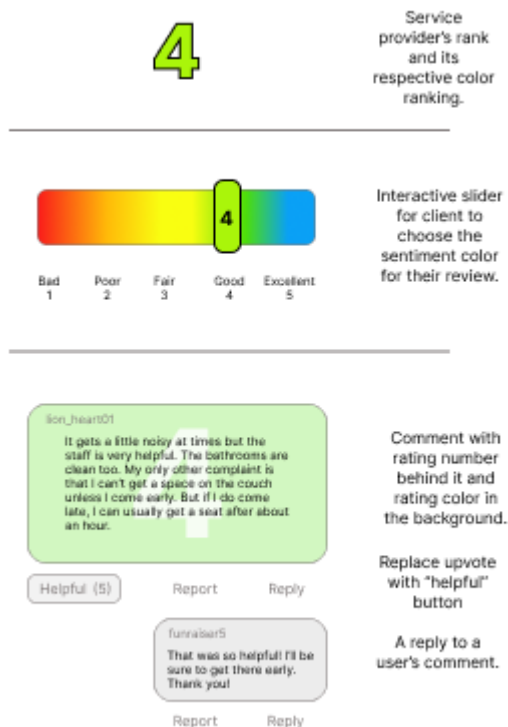
[continued]

Main Takeaways & Next Steps

1. Require logins to restrict clients who can leave reviews. These clients would likely need to be vetted through the participating service provider.
2. Replace up/downvote feature with a “helpful” button to encourage a positive environment. Incorporate the ability to use those votes as a way to arrange the reviews. E.g. by “helpfulness” (helpful votes are promoted to the top); by “date”; by “experience” (a user who gives more helpful reviews is promoted to the top). The word “helpfulness” appears to be more relevant to the users.
3. Add color to the background of comments based on star rating, (e.g. 1 = red, 2 = orange, 3 = yellow, 4 = green, 5 = blue). This could be a way to satisfy users’ desire for more color and ensure the same user comprehension that a standard star system affords.
4. Allow users to be semi-anonymous through the use of usernames. This allows users to have some obscurity for those who don’t want to be easily identified while also providing some accountability for what they write.
5. Allow users to reply to reviews as they have expressed a desire to help those in crisis.
6. Consider what the character limit should be. One participant expressed the desire for no limitation on character limits. We will want to find a balance that allows clients to fully express themselves while simultaneously encouraging them to be concise.
7. Add a “report” button to crowdsource moderation of offensive content and alert staff.
8. Consider rounding aggregate scores to the nearest .5 points. This allows room for service providers to improve their score before it drops to a point where it can negatively affect the perception of that organization. Conversely, it punishes service providers who do not take action to rectify issues by rounding down. This can be promoted as a beneficial feature for organizations that allows them a grace period for improvement.

9. Consider a pop-up reminder on conduct before submission of any written content.
10. Make the “Traffic Chart” optional and for organizations willing to display it, have them use verbiage such as, “temporary service reduction” or “services temporarily reduced” to protect vulnerable groups.
11. Consider making the “View all” hypertext on the main review page larger or bolder as it was not easily noticed.
12. Consider checking in with service providers at regular intervals to ensure they maintain a process for resolving issues brought up by their clientele.

UI Concept



Future Iteration User Testing

1. Explore badges for service providers as a way to advertise their success. Explore badges for clients to encourage them to give more helpful reviews. Requisites for client

badges could be, for example, attaining 10 upvotes in total, or 15 upvotes in a month. Requisites for service providers would be more involved. Badges should be young and hip, with a one to three-word description below them.

2. Explore support for adding pictures to reviews.
3. Consider interactions when a user or end-user makes a submission. For example, fireworks when a review is submitted; a balloon "Thank You!" fills the screen on a reply; an expanding thumbs up when holding down on it.

Observations

1. User Accessibility and Preferences: Users access the internet predominantly through mobile devices and have varying preferences for anonymity and visibility in reviews. They value detailed, actionable feedback and seek features that enhance interactivity, such as replying to reviews and using mentions (@username).

2. User Interface: The interface elements like the "Add Review" button and star rating system were noticed and used effectively by the participants. However, the smiley rating system received mixed reactions, with some finding it childish or confusing.

3. Information Needs: Participants expressed a desire for more detailed information on services, including visual aids (like pictures) and organizational details. They also wanted more control over how reviews are displayed (e.g., sorting by recency or relevance).

4. Engagement and Response: There's a strong desire for interaction between clients and service providers. Users suggested features like badges or color-coded reviews to represent sentiments or service quality, indicating a need for a more dynamic and engaging feedback system.

5. Security and Privacy Concerns: Concerns about anonymity versus transparency, especially regarding who is responding to reviews and how feedback is managed and displayed.

6. Cultural and Language Considerations: Participants indicated a need for multilingual support and culturally sensitive design, such as considering non-English speakers and incorporating LGBTQIA2S+-friendly elements.

Insights

1. Enhancing Usability: The feedback suggests a need for an intuitive, engaging interface that accommodates various user preferences and accessibility needs. Simplifying the smiley system or enhancing it to be more intuitive could improve user satisfaction.

2. Building Trust through Transparency: Providing options for users to choose between anonymous and non-anonymous feedback, and clearly indicating who responds to reviews, could enhance trust in the platform.

3. Encouraging Engagement: Features like badges, color-coded sentiments, and the ability to reply to reviews could foster a more interactive community, encouraging users to provide more feedback.

4. Cultural and Language Inclusivity: Incorporating multilingual support and culturally inclusive design elements could broaden the app's appeal and usability, making it more accessible to a diverse user base.

Ranked Priorities for Next Steps

1. Interface Redesign: Address the mixed feedback on the smiley system and explore more universally understandable icons or rating systems. Consider incorporating visual elements like badges or colors that reflect review sentiments. Perhaps a spectrum scale with a legend at the top of the screen will be useful in conveying meaning to each segment. Allow users to select a color to represent their overall experience while utilizing that same legend. That color could go behind their typed review and eliminate the need for a scale that uses a separate number value or other scales.

2. Enhanced Review Features: Implement features that allow users to sort reviews by different criteria and reply to reviews. Also, consider integrating a feature that allows for more detailed and structured feedback.

3. Privacy and Interaction Options: Develop clear options for users to choose how their identity is displayed in reviews and how they interact with service providers.

4. Multilingual and Cultural Adaptations: Prioritize the development of multilingual support and incorporate design elements that are inclusive of diverse cultural backgrounds.

5. Feedback and Iteration: Continue gathering user feedback on the redesigned elements and new features, ensuring that changes align with user needs and preferences.

Visualizations and Additional Elements

Visualizations such as user flow charts or heat maps could illustrate how users interact with different features of the app. Also, developing personas based on the feedback could help in designing features that cater specifically to the needs of different user groups.

[*Version 2*]

UX Research Report: YourPeer Review App

Introduction

This report synthesizes the findings from two UX research sessions conducted to evaluate the experience of clients providing feedback through the YourPeer web application's new review feature. Participants were recruited from two social service providers serving young adults. The report outlines observations, insights, and prioritized next steps to improve the user experience of the review app.

Observations

- **Users understand and navigate star rating systems well.** While some users prefer a wider range of colors or additional information displayed with stars, they generally grasped this rating system.

- **Emojis for ratings received mixed reviews.** While some users found them childish, others appreciated their simplicity, particularly non-English speakers.
- **Text comments are still desired for detailed feedback.** Users want to express themselves beyond star ratings or emojis, and some would like the ability to reply to other reviews.
- **Anonymity is preferred, but accountability is also desired.** There is a strong preference for anonymity when leaving reviews. However, some users also want to see who responds to their reviews and hold service providers accountable for addressing issues.
- **Visual elements have potential but require careful design.** Charts and colors can be helpful, but they need to be clear, well-designed, and culturally sensitive.

Insights

- **The star rating system is a solid foundation for user ratings, but it can be enhanced.** Consider incorporating a wider range of colors or additional information alongside the star ratings to provide users with more granular rating options.
- **Emojis as a rating system may be best offered as an optional feature.** This caters to users who find them helpful while not alienating those who don't.
- **Text comments are essential for a comprehensive review experience.** Provide a clear and easy-to-use text input field for users to elaborate on their feedback.
- **Balancing anonymity and accountability requires a nuanced approach.** Explore allowing users to choose between anonymous and identified reviews, while also ensuring clear communication about how providers will respond to feedback.

- **Invest in user-friendly and visually appealing design.** Prioritize clear information architecture, intuitive navigation, and culturally sensitive color schemes and icons.

Prioritized Next Steps

1. **Refine the star rating system.** Gather user input on the ideal number of color options or additional information to display alongside the star ratings.
2. **Implement emojis as an optional rating feature.** Allow users to choose between star ratings, emojis, or both for their overall rating.
3. **Develop a user-friendly text input field for comments.** Ensure the field is clear, easy to locate, and supports a reasonable character limit.
4. **Designate a team to address user concerns raised in reviews.** Establish a clear process for how providers will respond to both anonymous and identified reviews.
5. **Conduct usability testing on the visual design.** Gather user feedback on the clarity, navigation, and cultural sensitivity of the visual elements within the review app.

Additional Considerations

- Explore gamification elements like badges to incentivize users to leave reviews and promote positive interactions within the app.
- Investigate the feasibility of translating reviews into multiple languages to enhance accessibility for non-English speakers.
- Consider incorporating accessibility features for users with visual impairments or other disabilities.

By implementing these recommendations and addressing the considerations outlined above, the YourPeer review app can become a valuable tool for clients to provide feedback and for service providers to improve their services.